

Shifted-zeta evolution and Wilson lines

A Loewner realization program for cumulative positivity

Drafted for Edward Baker

20 September 2026 – Version 0.3

Abstract

The shifted completed-zeta quotient determines an exact causal evolution $\partial_\omega V_{\omega,L} = -G_{\omega,L} V_{\omega,L}$ on a finite boundary interval. We propose using this equation to prescribe the effective evolution of a normalized Wilson observable on Loewner-generated contours. The equation is known arithmetic input; its realization by fields, contours and endpoint states is the research hypothesis. The desired physical identity expresses the cumulative defect $I - V_{\omega,L}^* V_{\omega,L}$ as a positive norm. Contraction along a sequence with $L \rightarrow \infty$ and $\omega \downarrow 0$ would then imply the classical Weil positivity criterion. We explain the normalization, the required closure of Wilson variation, the distinction between instantaneous and cumulative positivity, and the separate gluing problem when the interval grows. Existing kernel, supersymmetry, endpoint and reflection calculations constrain this proposal; their proofs and diagnostics are collected in the companion *Supplementary information*. No matching physical transfer, cumulative norm identity, or all-depth continuation is established here.

Status. Exposition of an open research program, with background identities and conditional implications distinguished from construction hypotheses. Prepared with OpenAI GPT-6 (Codex) assistance for Edward Baker; see Appendix A.

Contents

1	The program: prescribe the arithmetic evolution	2
1.1	The proposed chain of implications	2
1.2	The role of the two papers	3
1.3	Sources and relation to earlier work	3
2	The arithmetic positivity target	3
2.1	The compactly supported Weil form	4
2.2	The positive kinetic term and the indispensable local term	4
3	The exact shifted-zeta evolution	5
3.1	The transfer and its causal generator	5
3.2	The equation to be realized	6
3.3	The accumulated defect and the central limit	7
4	The Wilson–Loewner realization hypothesis	7
4.1	An observable before a driver	7
4.2	The insertion identity that must close	8
4.3	Three parameters that must be related explicitly	8

5	What the existing calculations contribute	9
5.1	A spectral ingredient, with a fixed subtraction sign	9
5.2	Contour freedom and endpoint compatibility	9
5.3	A nontrivial response, with an unfinished physical sum	9
6	Reflection as a possible explanation of cumulative positivity	10
6.1	The identity the positive pairing must supply	10
6.2	What ordinary reflection currently establishes	10
6.3	Why the target is the accumulated norm	11
7	The depth–shift continuation problem	11
7.1	A sufficient diagonal route	11
7.2	What is meant by a critical path	11
7.3	Length extension has its own exact constraint	12
7.4	The all-depth requirement	12
8	Research agenda and present status	13
8.1	The first discriminating tasks	13
8.2	A compact statement ledger	13
A	Provenance and contribution disclosure	14

1 The program: prescribe the arithmetic evolution

The organizing proposal is to start with the exact shifted-zeta differential equation and ask which field-dependent observable can realize it. Loewner evolution supplies a controlled family of contours; a supersymmetric defect theory supplies Wilson transport, endpoint matter and candidate positive pairings. Their effective boundary transfer is required to satisfy the arithmetic equation. The shift equation thereby becomes a constraint on the choice of observable and contour evolution, rather than a resemblance to be tested only after those choices have been made.

This is an inverse realization problem. An equation for an operator on boundary functions does not by itself determine a real Loewner driver, a gauge connection or a quantum expectation. In particular, the arithmetic generator is a nonlocal operator on an infinite-dimensional function space, whereas a Wilson connection initially acts on color indices along a curve. An explicit boundary construction and an insertion identity must connect the two.

1.1 The proposed chain of implications

Write $V_{\omega,L}$ for the causal arithmetic transfer at shift ω on an interval of length L . Its exact evolution and initial condition are

$$\partial_{\omega} V_{\omega,L} = -G_{\omega,L} V_{\omega,L}, \quad V_{0,L} = I.$$

The generator contains the gamma contribution, a fixed local term, two pole terms and the prime-power translations. The objective is an independently defined Wilson transfer $\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L}$ satisfying this equation, together with uniqueness in the relevant causal class, so that $\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L} = V_{\omega,L}$.

A second identity should explain its norm:

$$\|f\|^2 = \|\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L} f\|^2 + \|\mathcal{B}_{\omega,L} f\|^2.$$

Here $\mathcal{B}$ would be an independently constructed amplitude map into a positive Hilbert space, potentially supplied by a reflected Wilson network. This would prove contraction at the parameters where the construction is valid. If those parameters include $L_j \rightarrow \infty$ and $\omega_j \downarrow 0$, the zero-shift limit yields the full central Weil form on every compact support. The precise conditional implication is Proposition 7.1.

There are therefore three substantive tasks: derive the prescribed evolution from the observable, establish the cumulative norm identity, and continue the construction to unbounded interval length while the shift tends to zero. The known arithmetic differential equation supplies a target for these tasks; it does not discharge any of them.

1.2 The role of the two papers

This exposition retains the facts needed to assess that chain of implications. Section 2 states the full positivity target, including the local constant w_0 . Section 3 derives the transfer and defect evolutions. Sections 4–6 formulate the physical hypothesis and explain the constraints from the existing calculations. Section 7 states the depth–shift continuation problem, and Section 8 gives the next discriminating tasks.

The companion *Supplementary information* [1] contains the detailed constructions, proofs and diagnostics. A result that materially restricts the proposed realization is summarized here even when its derivation is deferred there. This division lets the main argument be read without the Clifford algebra or perturbative integrals, while keeping those calculations available as explicit tests of a candidate model.

1.3 Sources and relation to earlier work

The scalar-coupled Wilson framework originates in Maldacena’s construction [2]; tangent-dependent scalar couplings and common line supersymmetry are due to Zarembo [3]. The D3–D5 defect theory and its projector conventions come from DeWolfe–Freedman–Ooguri and Gaiotto–Witten [4, 5]. Baker’s open Wilson lines and semicircle are the endpoint controls [6]. We use chordal Loewner normalization as in Lawler [7]. The Loewner/CFT relation of Bauer–Bernard [8] motivates looking for a closed averaged observable, but supplies no Wilson realization of the arithmetic generator here.

Ordinary reflection and its distinction from an internal rotation are guided by Osterwalder–Schrader and Dorn–Pershin [9, 10]. The compact-support Weil criterion is classical; our convention agrees with Suzuki [11]. The exact shift evolution is reproduced from the shared background [16]. The Wilson-lines, Loewner and fractional-dimension investigations supply the previous realization tests [12, 14, 15]. The cumulative-storage continuation comes from the shifted-zeta program [19, 18]. The new organization follows Baker’s proposal recorded in the shift-flow research note [17]; it is a change in the research question, not a claim to have solved the inverse problem.

2 The arithmetic positivity target

This section fixes the target independently of any field-theory model. The formulas also explain why positivity of a single covariance kernel would be insufficient.

2.1 The compactly supported Weil form

Let $I_L = (-L/2, L/2)$, with $L > 0$, and let $f \in C_c^\infty(I_L; \mathbb{C})$. Write F for its zero extension to $\mathbb{R}$ and use

$$\widehat{F}(\tau) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} e^{-i\tau x} F(x) dx, \quad \langle f, g \rangle = \int_{I_L} \overline{f(x)} g(x) dx. \quad (2.1)$$

For $a > 0$, define the compressed shift $T_a f(x) = F(x - a)$ on I_L . Let $\psi = \Gamma'/\Gamma$ be the digamma function, and let $\Lambda(n) = \log p$ when $n = p^k$, p prime and $k \geq 1$, and zero otherwise. Finally put

$$C(f) = \int_{I_L} f(x) \cosh(x/2) dx, \quad S(f) = \int_{I_L} f(x) \sinh(x/2) dx. \quad (2.2)$$

The normalization of the program is

$$\begin{aligned} Q_{0,L}[f] &= \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} [\operatorname{Re} \psi(\tfrac{1}{4} + \tfrac{i\tau}{2}) - \log \pi] |\widehat{F}(\tau)|^2 d\tau + 2|C(f)|^2 - 2|S(f)|^2 \\ &\quad - \sum_{\substack{n \geq 2 \\ \log n < L}} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} \langle f, (T_{\log n} + T_{\log n}^*) f \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (2.3)$$

The prime-power sum is finite on a fixed interval. The pole term is indefinite, and the archimedean multiplier includes its local constant. Neither may be dropped in a positivity argument.

For comparison with the usual explicit formula, set $h = F * \bar{F}$, where $\bar{F}(x) = \overline{F(-x)}$. The two prime sums in the Weil functional give the last line of (2.3); its $e^{x/2} + e^{-x/2}$ term gives $2|C|^2 - 2|S|^2$. Its archimedean distribution has Fourier multiplier $\operatorname{Re} \psi(1/4 + i\tau/2) - \log \pi$. Thus $Q_{0,L}[f] = W(F * \bar{F})$ in the convention of [11, p. 1]. In particular the weight is $\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$.

Theorem 2.1 (Weil positivity criterion, used as background). *RH holds if and only if $Q_{0,L}[f] \geq 0$ for every $L > 0$ and every $f \in C_c^\infty(I_L; \mathbb{C})$.*

The equivalence is the classical criterion, not a result of the present construction. Every compact support lies in one such interval, so an unbounded sequence of interval lengths suffices. A finite collection of lengths or numerical matrices does not.

2.2 The positive kinetic term and the indispensable local term

The numbers $a_n = 2n + 1/2$, $n \geq 0$, are the decay rates $1/2, 5/2, 9/2, \dots$ in the exponential expansion

$$n_\Gamma(u) = \frac{e^{-u/2}}{1 - e^{-2u}} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} e^{-a_n u}, \quad u > 0. \quad (2.4)$$

They arise by expanding a geometric series, and are not zeta zeros or prime-power coefficients. In the free defect construction they also appear as the even angular rates $\ell + 1/2$ with $\ell = 2n$; the physical derivation is in [1, Section S2]. Put

$$b(\tau^2) = \operatorname{Re} \psi(\tfrac{1}{4} + \tfrac{i\tau}{2}) - \psi(\tfrac{1}{4}) = 2 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{\tau^2}{a_n(a_n^2 + \tau^2)} \geq 0, \quad w_0 = \psi(\tfrac{1}{4}) - \log \pi < 0. \quad (2.5)$$

The exact digamma value is

$$\psi(\tfrac{1}{4}) = -\gamma - \frac{\pi}{2} - 3 \log 2, \quad w_0 = -\gamma - \frac{\pi}{2} - 3 \log 2 - \log \pi \simeq -5.37218342, \quad (2.6)$$

where γ is Euler's constant. Thus $\psi(1/4)$ is not equal to $\log \pi$. Adding and subtracting $\psi(1/4)$ in the original multiplier gives the exact identity

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Re} \psi\left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{i\tau}{2}\right) - \log \pi &= [\operatorname{Re} \psi\left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{i\tau}{2}\right) - \psi\left(\frac{1}{4}\right)] + [\psi\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) - \log \pi] \\ &= b(\tau^2) + w_0. \end{aligned} \quad (2.7)$$

Thus w_0 is the remainder after separating the nonnegative multiplier $b(\tau^2)$; it is already present in (2.3), not an additional term introduced into the form.

The series in (2.5) follows by subtracting the convergent digamma partial fractions. Each exponential in (2.4) satisfies $\int_0^\infty e^{-au}(1 - \cos \tau u) du = \tau^2/[a(a^2 + \tau^2)]$. Plancherel therefore gives

$$\mathcal{E}_\Gamma[F] := \int_0^\infty n_\Gamma(u) \|F(\cdot + u) - F\|_2^2 du = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} b(\tau^2) |\widehat{F}(\tau)|^2 d\tau. \quad (2.8)$$

Using (2.7) and $\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} |\widehat{F}(\tau)|^2 d\tau = \|f\|_2^2$, the archimedean contribution becomes

$$\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} [\operatorname{Re} \psi\left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{i\tau}{2}\right) - \log \pi] |\widehat{F}(\tau)|^2 d\tau = \mathcal{E}_\Gamma[F] + w_0 \|f\|_2^2. \quad (2.9)$$

Substituting this identity into (2.3) rewrites the full target as

$$\begin{aligned} Q_{0,L}[f] &= \mathcal{E}_\Gamma[F] + w_0 \|f\|_2^2 + 2|C(f)|^2 - 2|S(f)|^2 \\ &\quad - \sum_{\substack{n \geq 2 \\ \log n < L}} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} \langle f, (T_{\log n} + T_{\log n}^*) f \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (2.10)$$

Here $w_0 \|f\|_2^2 = w_0 \int_{I_L} |f(x)|^2 dx$ is the fixed negative local term. The positive difference energy is only one part of the desired form: its local term, pole contribution and prime-power translations must all be retained.

The natural form domain on a fixed interval is given by zero extensions with $\int \log(2 + |\tau|) |\widehat{F}(\tau)|^2 d\tau < \infty$. Indeed $b(\tau^2)$ grows logarithmically at infinity, whereas the pole and finite translation terms are bounded forms on $L^2(I_L)$. This explains the logarithmic form domain and semiboundedness of the localized form. For the logical proof target in Theorem 2.1, the smooth compactly supported class is enough.

3 The exact shifted-zeta evolution

3.1 The transfer and its causal generator

Define

$$\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2} s(s-1) \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s), \quad H(p) = \xi\left(\frac{1}{2} + p\right). \quad (3.1)$$

For $0 < \omega \leq 1/2$, set

$$K_\omega(p) = \frac{H(p-\omega)}{H(p+\omega)}, \quad a_\omega(p) = \frac{H'(p-\omega)}{H(p-\omega)} + \frac{H'(p+\omega)}{H(p+\omega)}. \quad (3.2)$$

Logarithmic differentiation gives $\partial_\omega K_\omega = -a_\omega K_\omega$. The functional equation gives $|K_\omega(i\tau)| = 1$ wherever the ratio is defined. This boundary identity alone does not give a bounded causal transfer on the unweighted whole line.

Instead take inverse Laplace transforms on $\text{Re } p = \sigma > 1$, where the denominator is nonzero and the Dirichlet series converge. If k_ω is the causal kernel, define

$$V_{\omega,L}f = (k_\omega * F)|_{I_L}, \quad V_{0,L} = I. \quad (3.3)$$

For positive shift the kernel is locally integrable and the finite-window operator is bounded. The exact Beta-kernel, integer comb and rational correction are given in [1, Section S1.4]; positivity of the Beta/combin part does not imply contraction of the full transfer.

Let $G_{\omega,L}$ be the compressed causal realization of a_ω on the same Laplace line. Its symmetric quadratic form is

$$Q_{\omega,L}[g] = \text{Re} \langle g, G_{\omega,L}g \rangle. \quad (3.4)$$

This notation is interpreted as a form when the operator pairing is not separately defined. The natural form domain has logarithmic Fourier weight as in Section 2; it need not be the full operator domain of the nonsymmetric generator. Smooth compactly supported tests and their positive-shift evolutions suffice for the identities below.

3.2 The equation to be realized

Causality permits the scalar transfer identity to be compressed to the finite interval: an intermediate value beyond its right endpoint cannot return to the interval, and the input has no values before its left endpoint. The exact equation is

$$\boxed{\partial_\omega V_{\omega,L} = -G_{\omega,L}V_{\omega,L}, \quad V_{0,L} = I.} \quad (3.5)$$

It is the boxed equation adjacent to the energy derivative in the shared background [16]. It holds on admissible inputs, with a strong initial limit and a right derivative at zero on smooth tests. No operator-norm derivative at zero is asserted.

The zero-shift symbol shows the matching problem explicitly:

$$\begin{aligned} a_0(p) = & w_0 + 2 \int_0^\infty n \Gamma(u) (1 - e^{-pu}) \, du + \frac{2}{p + 1/2} + \frac{2}{p - 1/2} \\ & - 2 \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} e^{-p \log n}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.6)$$

Its real quadratic form is exactly $Q_{0,L}$, including the fixed local constant, the pole response and the prime delays. At positive shift the prime term in a_ω is

$$-2 \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} \cosh(\omega \log n) e^{-p \log n}.$$

The transfer itself contains the fuller multiplicative integer comb, not just the prime-power part of its logarithmic derivative.

Thus (3.5) supplies a detailed prescription. A physical construction must reproduce every component of (3.6), and its finite-shift continuation, with these coefficients. Choosing a contour with a suggestive gamma spectrum addresses only one component.

3.3 The accumulated defect and the central limit

Put

$$D_{\omega,L} = I - V_{\omega,L}^* V_{\omega,L}. \quad (3.7)$$

The product rule at positive shift yields the second evolution equation

$$\partial_\omega D_{\omega,L} = V_{\omega,L}^* (G_{\omega,L}^* + G_{\omega,L}) V_{\omega,L}, \quad D_{0,L} = 0. \quad (3.8)$$

The right side is the pullback of the symmetric form $2Q_{\omega,L}$. Equivalently one uses the bounded positive-shift product-rule expression $(G_{\omega,L} V_{\omega,L})^* V_{\omega,L} + V_{\omega,L}^* (G_{\omega,L} V_{\omega,L})$. This avoids assuming that the separate adjoint generator acts on every evolved input.

For $f \in C_c^\infty(I_L)$, integration and the initial limit give

$$\langle f, D_{\omega,L} f \rangle = \|f\|^2 - \|V_{\omega,L} f\|^2 = 2 \int_0^\omega Q_{s,L}[V_{s,L} f] \, ds, \quad (3.9)$$

$$Q_{0,L}[f] = \lim_{\omega \downarrow 0} \frac{\langle f, D_{\omega,L} f \rangle}{2\omega}. \quad (3.10)$$

The running shift s changes both the form and the input to it. The analytic justification in the shared background uses the gamma-ratio bounds $|\partial_\omega^j K_\omega(\sigma + i\tau)| \leq C_\sigma (1 + \log(2 + |\tau|))^j (2 + |\tau|)^{-\omega}$ for $j = 0, 1, 2$: these give positive-shift smoothing and differentiability, and dominated convergence on smooth inputs at zero. No inverse of $V_{\omega,L}$ is needed.

The positivity target is $D_{\omega,L} \succeq 0$, or equivalently $\|V_{\omega,L}\| \leq 1$. Requiring all the instantaneous $Q_{s,L}$ to be positive would suffice, but is a stronger demand than positivity of their accumulated pullback in (3.9). This distinction determines the proposed role of the reflected network in Section 6.

4 The Wilson–Loewner realization hypothesis

4.1 An observable before a driver

A physical candidate must specify boundary input and output spaces, a field theory and regulator, endpoint states, a reference color sector, a physical adjoint, a family or ensemble of contours, and a normalization. After a fixed identification of its boundary spaces with $L^2(I_L)$, denote its averaged transfer by $\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L}$. It must act linearly on arbitrary boundary inputs, not merely return one scalar expectation for a single curve.

Research hypothesis 4.1 (Prescribed effective evolution). There is an independently specified Wilson boundary construction, with contours generated or parametrized by a Loewner evolution, whose normalized transfer is strongly initialized by $\mathcal{V}_{0,L} = I$ and satisfies

$$\partial_\omega \mathcal{V}_{\omega,L} = -G_{\omega,L} \mathcal{V}_{\omega,L} \quad (4.1)$$

on the arithmetic smooth core, in a causal evolution class for which this initial-value problem is unique.

Under these conditions $\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L} = V_{\omega,L}$. The existence of the construction, closure into the specified $G_{\omega,L}$, and the applicable uniqueness statement are all obligations of the hypothesis. Declaring $-G$ to be an abstract connection gives a formal ordered transport, but supplies none of the field or endpoint data. At fixed L the causal convolution generators formally commute on a common admissible core; the nontrivial question remains how a color-ordered field observable reduces to this boundary evolution.

The differential equation is intended to *select* admissible physical and geometric data. There may be no suitable scalar driver within a proposed family, or several such families. An explicit real driver or a driver law would be an output of solving that matching problem. We do not assert that the arithmetic equation already defines one.

4.2 The insertion identity that must close

For smooth matrix fields on a regular curve, set

$$\mathcal{M} = iA_\mu \dot{X}^\mu + \Phi v, \quad \Phi = n^I X_I, \quad v = |\dot{X}|.$$

Ordered Wilson transport obeys $\partial_s U(s, 0) = \mathcal{M}(s)U(s, 0)$. For a shape change $\eta = \delta X$ and a change δn , its exact variation is

$$\begin{aligned} \delta U(1, 0) &= C_1 U(1, 0) - U(1, 0) C_0 + \int_0^1 U(1, s) \mathcal{I}(s) U(s, 0) ds, \\ \mathcal{I} &= iF_{\nu\mu} \eta^\nu \dot{X}^\mu + v D_\nu \Phi \eta^\nu + \Phi \frac{\dot{X} \cdot \dot{\eta}}{v} + v X_I \delta n^I, \quad C_s = iA_\nu \eta^\nu. \end{aligned} \tag{4.2}$$

The boundary terms combine with the variations of actual endpoint fields and their polarizations. The proof, conventions, tangent-map version and endpoint formula are in [1, Section S4].

To obtain (4.1), the averaged insertions and all normalization terms must act on boundary inputs as $-G_{\omega,L} \mathcal{V}_{\omega,L}$. Field equations, Ward identities or a controlled reduction must establish this closure. A universal formula depending only on the curve cannot do so: in the abelian example $A_x = cy$, a straight line at $y = 0$ has $U = 1$ for every c , but its transverse variation depends on c . This obstruction concerns bare transport; it leaves open a field-dependent averaged closure.

4.3 Three parameters that must be related explicitly

Use the chordal equation

$$\partial_t g_t(z) = \frac{2}{g_t(z) - u_t}, \quad \text{hcap} = 2t, \tag{4.3}$$

where u_t is a real driver, distinguished from Wilson transport U . For a smooth reference curve $\zeta(s)$ in a region where $f_t = g_t^{-1}$ is regular,

$$X_t(s) = f_t(\zeta(s)), \quad \partial_t X_t(s) = -\frac{2f'_t(\zeta(s))}{\zeta(s) - u_t}.$$

These velocities can be inserted into (4.2); they do not define transport at a singular growing tip. A stochastic trace would need additional regularization and a defined limiting observable.

At fixed L , a dictionary $\omega = \omega(t)$ would require

$$\partial_t \mathcal{V}_{\omega(t),L} = -\dot{\omega}(t) G_{\omega(t),L} \mathcal{V}_{\omega(t),L}. \tag{4.4}$$

Loewner capacity t , arithmetic shift ω , and support length L have different meanings. Even the explicit constant-driver semicircle dictionary in [1, Section S3] identifies neither t nor the logarithmic endpoint radius with ω . When L changes, so do the space and compression; the fixed-window equation (4.4) omits that change. Section 7 treats it as a separate finite gluing step.

5 What the existing calculations contribute

The previous calculations provide candidate ingredients and restrictions on a realization. They do not yet supply the effective transfer of Hypothesis 4.1.

5.1 A spectral ingredient, with a fixed subtraction sign

A free three-dimensional defect scalar in logarithmic radial coordinates has angular rates $\ell + 1/2$. Even Poisson smearing selects $\ell = 2n$ and gives, for $0 \leq \rho < 1$,

$$C_\rho(u) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \rho^{4n} e^{-a_n |u|} = \frac{e^{-|u|/2}}{1 - \rho^4 e^{-2|u|}}. \quad (5.1)$$

This is a positive covariance tending to $n_\Gamma(|u|)$ off the diagonal. If T_ρ denotes convolution by C_ρ and $M_\rho = \widehat{C}_\rho(0)$, the positive difference form is $M_\rho I - T_\rho$, whose limit is $\mathcal{E}_\Gamma$. The opposite subtraction has the wrong high-frequency sign, and a finite contact constant cannot repair it. The auxiliary Gaussian mode model also produces the gamma partition ratio, but neither a physical projection to the required multiplicities nor its identification as a boundary transfer is established [1, Section S2].

These results explain why defect matter is relevant and fix a sign that a candidate must respect. They supply neither w_0 by themselves nor the pole and arithmetic terms in (3.6). The exact positive Beta/comb factorization likewise retains an essential rational subtraction [1, Section S1.4].

5.2 Contour freedom and endpoint compatibility

The inherited common-reference semicircles become vertical slits after inversion and have constant Loewner driving. Their rigidity holds for one fixed scalar prescription and one specified bulk charge. A tangent-dependent scalar coupling changes that restriction: with the full chiral D3–D5 projector, an oriented real tangent isometry admits a common complex charge space of dimension two in a normal plane and dimension one across all defect directions. These are exact statements in the stated Euclidean Clifford module [1, Sections S3 and S5].

Contour freedom does not complete the observable. In this constant-map Poincare-charge ansatz, ordinary scalar endpoints annihilated by the same charge have zero mutual free contraction. Their bilinear also has nonzero residual R charge, giving a vanishing expectation in an invariant vacuum. Pairing an endpoint with its physical adjoint restores a nonzero contraction but changes the supersymmetry conditions [1, Section S6]. Baker’s original conformal semicircle is a nonzero control outside that restricted ansatz, not an excluded construction.

A candidate should therefore be tested for a nonzero normalized endpoint pairing before trying to extract its arithmetic generator. A shared line supercharge alone does not ensure such a pairing.

5.3 A nontrivial response, with an unfinished physical sum

Ordinary time reflection gives a consistent classical adjoint and a positive free endpoint kernel. A smooth polynomial bulge can join its reflected branch without a fixed-angle cusp. In the direct Feynman-gauge Gaussian bulk-exchange sector, the stripped self-response is

$$I(\eta) = \left(\frac{3}{2} - 2 \log 2\right) \eta^2 + O(\eta^4), \quad \frac{3}{2} - 2 \log 2 > 0. \quad (5.2)$$

The construction and remainder estimate are in [1, Sections S7–S8]. Endpoint-to-line exchange, defect interactions, self-energies and counterterms are still needed for the full response. Thus the

coefficient is a concrete insertion test, not an effective arithmetic generator or an all-order protection theorem.

The distinction between supersymmetry and a positive norm is visible even abstractly: $Q\psi = 0$ and $\delta\psi = Q\lambda$ give $\delta\|\psi\|^2 = 2\operatorname{Re}\langle Q^\dagger\psi, \lambda \rangle$, which need not vanish. A successful reduction must handle both the chosen charge and the physical adjoint.

6 Reflection as a possible explanation of cumulative positivity

6.1 The identity the positive pairing must supply

The second construction target is a positive Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{\omega,L}$ and a linear amplitude map $\mathcal{B}_{\omega,L} : L^2(I_L) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_{\omega,L}$ such that

$$\|f\|_{L^2(I_L)}^2 = \|\mathcal{V}_{\omega,L}f\|_{L^2(I_L)}^2 + \|\mathcal{B}_{\omega,L}f\|_{\mathcal{H}_{\omega,L}}^2. \quad (6.1)$$

This is a proposed physical balance law. Once the transfer matching has been proved, it implies

$$D_{\omega,L} = \mathcal{B}_{\omega,L}^* \mathcal{B}_{\omega,L} \succeq 0. \quad (6.2)$$

A proof first on a dense core, with bounded extensions, is enough. The initial normalization forces $\mathcal{B}_{0,L} = 0$ if the identity extends to zero shift.

The input and output norms in (6.1) are the fixed, unweighted arithmetic norms. A parameter-dependent physical metric requires an explicit isometric identification and the extra terms caused by its variation. Defining $\mathcal{B} = D^{1/2}$ after assuming $D \succeq 0$ would restate the desired conclusion; the amplitudes must be specified independently. A whole-line unitary model available only under RH also cannot be the starting proof.

6.2 What ordinary reflection currently establishes

For tangent map M and time reflection $R = \operatorname{diag}(-1, 1, 1, 1)$, the adjoint branch uses $N = -MR$ and reversed path ordering. If F_i is the Wilson-dressed endpoint vector at a common reference, the proposed network is

$$K_{ij} = \langle \Theta_0 F_i F_j \rangle.$$

A regulator with the appropriate reference color sector and Osterwalder–Schrader inequality would make this a Gram matrix. The interacting regulator, operator domain and positivity-preserving renormalization are assumptions, not established consequences of gauge invariance. The full construction and its scope are in [1, Section S7].

At free endpoint order the time-ray kernel is unconditionally positive:

$$K^{(0)}(r, s) = \frac{1}{r+s} = \int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda r} e^{-\lambda s} d\lambda, \quad r, s > 0. \quad (6.3)$$

After radial weights it gives $G_o(u) = 1/(2\cosh(u/2))$. This is only the opposite-ray part of $n_\Gamma(|u|) = (G_s(u) + G_o(u))/2$, where $G_s(u) = 1/(2\sinh(|u|/2))$. Moreover, a positive kernel of states has not been identified with the defect $D_{\omega,L}$. It needs a specified shift-dependent amplitude and the exact balance (6.1). The unmodified free kernel does not satisfy the required vanishing at zero shift.

Internal rotations that align the two scalar maps need not preserve this positive metric; explicit endpoint-doublet and odd-H counterexamples are retained in the companion. The positive ordinary adjoint is therefore a substantive part of the proposal.

6.3 Why the target is the accumulated norm

Equation (3.9) integrates the energy on the moving input $V_{s,L}f$. A reflected realization might explain the resulting positive norm without factoring each instantaneous $Q_{s,L}$. The shifted-zeta storage calculation records a useful distinction: at $L = \log 7$ and $\omega = 10^{-11}$, one exact polynomial input has a negative instantaneous quotient of about -2.998×10^{-27} but a positive cumulative quotient of about 8.7170×10^{-38} [20, Appendix A]. These inherited enclosures concern one input, not an all-input contraction bound. Nor do they show negativity of the actual evolving integrand, since $Q_{\omega,L}[f]$ and $Q_{\omega,L}[V_{\omega,L}f]$ use different inputs.

The example motivates allowing accumulated storage to carry the positivity argument. It does not establish the physical balance law or justify reversing a forward dissipation inequality.

7 The depth–shift continuation problem

7.1 A sufficient diagonal route

The end of the program requires a sequence of operator bounds, not a particular smooth curve in the parameter plane.

Proposition 7.1 (Sufficient depth–shift route). *Suppose $L_j \rightarrow \infty$, $0 < \omega_j \downarrow 0$, and $\|V_{\omega_j,L_j}\| \leq 1$ for every j . Then $Q_{0,L}[f] \geq 0$ for every $L > 0$ and $f \in C_c^\infty(I_L)$, and hence RH holds.*

Proof. Fix L and f . For large j , zero-extend f to I_{L_j} . Restriction of its output to I_L is $V_{\omega_j,L}f$, because the causal kernel is the same. Restriction cannot increase its norm, so $\|V_{\omega_j,L}f\| \leq \|f\|$. Divide its nonnegative defect by $2\omega_j$ and take the fixed-test limit (3.10). Theorem 2.1 completes the implication. $\square$

No rate coupling L_j to ω_j , uniform positive margin, or differentiable path is needed for this implication. Every bound must hold on all inputs at its selected pair. Finite matrices alone do not supply that assertion.

7.2 What is meant by a critical path

Here a critical path means a continuation along which a construction or rigorous estimate remains effective as depth grows and shift decreases. It is not an assumed boundary of the true contraction region. Under RH the positive-shift quotient is inner, so finite-window contraction holds throughout the parameter range; the parent Wilson-lines discussion makes this distinction [12]. There is also an unconditional anchor at $\omega = 1/2$ from the known innerness of the quotient [21, Section 1.4]. This anchor gives finite-window contraction, but does not automatically initialize the strict margins or physical data needed for a chosen continuation.

The earlier adaptive-shift estimate is a different, sufficient route. Assuming $Q_{0,L} \succeq m_L I > 0$, and writing $X_L f = x f$ on the centered interval, put

$$\kappa_L = \sup_{f \neq 0} \left(\frac{Q_{0,L}[X_L f]}{Q_{0,L}[f]} \right)^{1/2}. \quad (7.1)$$

With a finite proved bound on this form-multiplication norm, the inherited estimate is

$$Q_{\omega,L} \succeq \cos(2\omega\kappa_L) Q_{0,L}, \quad 0 \leq \omega\kappa_L \leq \pi/4 \quad [18]. \quad (7.2)$$

It gives a small-shift schedule after central positivity has been proved at that depth. It does not establish the central positivity needed to enlarge the interval. A lower estimate of κ_L from finitely many vectors cannot justify that schedule.

7.3 Length extension has its own exact constraint

Translate the interval to $(0, L + h)$ and split it into old and new pieces. Causality gives

$$V_{\omega, L+h} = \begin{pmatrix} X & 0 \\ Y & Z \end{pmatrix}, \quad X = V_{\omega, L}, \quad Z = V_{\omega, h}. \quad (7.3)$$

If X and Z are strict contractions in operator norm, set

$$E = I - X^*X, \quad F_{\text{out}} = I - ZZ^*.$$

The inherited cumulative-storage criterion is

$$\boxed{\|V_{\omega, L+h}\| \leq 1 \iff \|F_{\text{out}}^{-1/2} Y E^{-1/2}\| \leq 1.} \quad (7.4)$$

It measures cross-interval transfer in the old-input and new-output defect metrics. A strict inequality gives a strict contraction. The proof and the simultaneous depth-shift criterion are in [1, Section S9], following [19]. The diagonal strictness is required for the displayed inverses; a semidefinite boundary case needs a separate range formulation.

This suggests a precise physical gluing target: derive or bound the normalized cross map in (7.4), preserving its directions and cancellations. Separate worst-case scalar estimates can lose the information a continuation needs. If the shift also changes, the old and new defect metrics change as well; the finite-step Schur test in the companion keeps those changes. The fixed- L shift ODE alone is not that joint step.

For reflection-compatible coordinates one can use

$$P_{\omega, L} = \frac{2}{\omega} \operatorname{Re}[(I - V_{\omega, L})(I + V_{\omega, L})^{-1}].$$

Here $\operatorname{Re} A = (A + A^*)/2$ and the inverse exists for the positive-shift finite-window Volterra operator. The exact congruence

$$D_{\omega, L} = \frac{\omega}{2} (I + V_{\omega, L}^*) P_{\omega, L} (I + V_{\omega, L}) \quad (7.5)$$

preserves positivity and the normalized spatial coupling. These are useful coordinates, not an additional positivity result. At positive shift P is bounded, whereas $Q_{0, L}$ is an unbounded form; a core expansion does not give a uniform operator-norm approximation.

7.4 The all-depth requirement

A recursion with $L_{j+1} = L_j + h_j$ must establish $\sum_j h_j = \infty$ as well as $\omega_j \downarrow 0$. Local extendibility could otherwise accumulate at a finite length. Arithmetic delays and crossings of weak directions favor a finite step criterion over an assumed smooth critical-curve ODE. Decreasing the shift also cannot be justified by reversing forward dissipation; no bounded inverse of $V_{\omega, L}$ is assumed.

Numerical exploration should retain complete output norms and a rigorous bound on the unresolved input complement. In particular, $I - (\Pi V \Pi)^* (\Pi V \Pi)$ can look positive because output was discarded. The parent Loewner assembly is a reusable diagnostic tool, but a finite experiment neither proves (7.4) on the full space nor prevents finite-depth accumulation.

8 Research agenda and present status

The revised program starts from a known arithmetic evolution and asks for a physical derivation of its transfer and norm. The detailed work remains useful because it tests specific candidates for that derivation. The immediate priority is to define the candidate boundary operator precisely enough that its variation can be compared with (4.1).

8.1 The first discriminating tasks

First fix one field and endpoint construction: input/output identifications, reference color sector, regulator, adjoint and normalization, together with the meaning of ω . The existing free endpoint kernel is a control for nonzero pairing; a mere family of scalar expectations is not yet the required operator.

Next compute its effective insertion on a controlled sector. The exact Wilson variation supplies the terms, and (3.6) supplies the comparison. Record separately whether the local constant, gamma difference, pole terms and prime-power delays have been obtained. A missing component should remain an explicit obstruction rather than be absorbed into an unspecified normalization.

Then test the cumulative identity (6.1), or a physical form of the cross-interval inequality (7.4). For the current bulge candidate, the complete first interaction-order response is still relevant, including endpoint, defect and junction contributions. Its purpose is now to test closure and the norm balance. The detailed list of missing diagrams and the nonuniform flat-limit issue are retained in [1, Section S8.4].

Finally formulate one rigorous joint depth-shift step and the invariant needed to repeat it to unbounded depth. The new *critical-path* investigation is the place to develop that continuation, starting from the inherited storage criteria [17, 19]. No such step or all-depth bound is claimed by this restructuring.

8.2 A compact statement ledger

Ingredient	Present status
Arithmetic shift and defect ODEs	Exact inherited identities, with their causal and form domains.
Weil limit and diagonal implication	Background positivity criterion and a sufficient conditional route to RH; the required contractions remain to be proved.
Free tower and gamma model	Explicit spectral ingredients with a fixed subtraction sign; no complete transfer or physical mode selection.
Contour and Wilson variation tools	Exact smooth identities and scoped rigidity/closure restrictions; no arithmetic driver construction.
Chiral projectors and scalar endpoints	Compatible charges exist; the ordinary same-charge scalar pairing vanishes in the stated ansatz.
Ordinary reflected pairing	A nonzero positive free kernel; interacting positivity and its identification with cumulative storage remain open.
Smooth bulge response	A nonzero direct Gaussian bulk sector; the full interacting response and protection question remain open.

Ingredient	Present status (continued)
Physical transfer and positive balance	Research hypotheses, including exact generator closure, normalization, uniqueness and an independent amplitude map.
Depth-shift gluing	Exact conditional Schur criteria; their all-input estimates and an unbounded continuation remain open.

The companion preserves the technical evidence behind this ledger, including the 268 finite diagnostics. Their scope is signs, ranks, ordered variations and Gaussian integrals. They neither verify the new realization hypothesis nor certify interacting positivity or RH.

A Provenance and contribution disclosure

This version was restructured on 20 September 2026 by OpenAI GPT-6 (Codex), for Edward Baker, following Baker’s proposal to use the shared background’s shifted-zeta equation as the prescribed effective Wilson–Loewner evolution. It is a working research exposition, not a submitted or independently refereed paper. The author designation records for whom it was drafted and does not assert human verification of every derivation. The configured reasoning effort was not exposed to the assistant in this session and is not inferred.

The unified versions 0.1 and 0.2 remain unchanged in the dated draft archive. The explicit archimedean decomposition added in version 0.2 is retained in Section 2. Version 0.3 separates this program exposition from *Supplementary information* [1], which preserves the detailed field and contour calculations and their numerical controls. The shift-flow note [17] supplies the conceptual handoff. The shift and storage identities and the continuation algebra are inherited from [16, 18, 19], not new realization theorems of this draft.

The literature checks and original local sources are recorded in `MANUSCRIPT_SOURCES.json`; its restructuring entry records the additional inputs at this revision. The `BUILD_RECORD.json` binds both reviewed PDFs to their sources and supporting diagnostics. Dated snapshots include both standalone documents and have their own file-identity record. These records establish provenance and reproducibility, not mathematical correctness. No independent review of either document has been completed.

References

- [1] Drafted for E. Baker by OpenAI GPT-6 (Codex), *Supplementary information: tools for the shifted-zeta Wilson–Loewner program*, version 0.3, 20 September 2026. Companion working paper, `supplementary-information.pdf` and `supplementary-information.tex`, in the same package.
- [2] J. M. Maldacena, *Wilson loops in large N field theories*, Physical Review Letters **80** (1998), 4859–4862, [arXiv:hep-th/9803002](#).
- [3] K. Zarembo, *Supersymmetric Wilson loops*, Nuclear Physics B **643** (2002), 157–171, [arXiv:hep-th/0205160](#).
- [4] O. DeWolfe, D. Z. Freedman and H. Ooguri, *Holography and defect conformal field theories*, Physical Review D **66** (2002), 025009, [arXiv:hep-th/0111135](#).

- [5] D. Gaiotto and E. Witten, *Supersymmetric boundary conditions in $\mathcal{N} = 4$ super Yang–Mills theory*, Journal of Statistical Physics **135** (2009), 789–855, [arXiv:0804.2902](#).
- [6] E. B. Baker III, *Supersymmetric open Wilson lines*, Journal of High Energy Physics **03** (2011), 140, [arXiv:1102.4948](#).
- [7] G. F. Lawler, *Schramm–Loewner evolution (SLE)*, lecture notes, especially Lecture 2, Proposition 2.17 and equation (2.8), [author’s PDF](#), accessed 19 September 2026.
- [8] M. Bauer and D. Bernard, *Conformal field theories of stochastic Loewner evolutions*, Communications in Mathematical Physics **239** (2003), 493–521, [arXiv:hep-th/0210015](#).
- [9] K. Osterwalder and R. Schrader, *Axioms for Euclidean Green’s functions*, Communications in Mathematical Physics **31** (1973), 83–112, [doi:10.1007/BF01645738](#).
- [10] H. Dorn and V. D. Pershin, *Concavity of the $Q\bar{Q}$ potential in $\mathcal{N} = 4$ super Yang–Mills gauge theory and AdS/CFT duality*, Physics Letters B **461** (1999), 338–344, [arXiv:hep-th/9906073v3](#).
- [11] M. Suzuki, *Weil’s quadratic form via the screw function*, preprint (2026), version 2, [arXiv:2606.09096v2](#). Used for the classical compact-support Weil criterion and conventions; its proposed limiting spectral construction is not assumed here.
- [12] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *Deformation flows for the shifted Weil family: the transfer as an all-pass filter*, working draft 0.8, 17 September 2026, and endpoint continuation notes, 18–19 September 2026. Repository investigation [papers/susy-positivity/investigations/wilson-lines/](#). Internal research, with model-assisted contributions disclosed in the source documents.
- [13] OpenAI GPT-6 (Codex), for Edward Baker, *Angular smearing, the finite difference form, and a Robin model of the shift*, research note, 19 September 2026, in the Wilson-lines investigation, [notes/ANGULAR_SMEARING_AND_ROBIN_MODEL_20260919.md](#).
- [14] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *The Markov part of the shifted Weil transfer*, working draft 0.3, 18 September 2026. Repository investigation [papers/susy-positivity/investigations/loewner/](#). Internal research; its direct realization proposal was closed within the tested scope.
- [15] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *A scattering matrix without a space*, working draft 0.1, 18 September 2026. Repository investigation [papers/susy-positivity/investigations/fractional-dimension/](#). Internal research; the continued lattice count and its limitations are discussed in its Section 6.
- [16] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *Shared background for the supersymmetric positivity program*, repository source [papers/susy-positivity/background_section.tex](#), state consulted 19 September 2026. In particular, the boxed transfer and defect equations beside the energy derivative and the sufficient depth–shift implication.
- [17] OpenAI GPT-6 (Codex), for Edward Baker, *Prescribed shift evolution, cumulative storage, and a depth–shift continuation*, research note, 19 September 2026, [notes/SHIFT_FLOW_CUMULATIVE_STORAGE_AND_CRITICAL_PATH_20260919.md](#) in the Wilson–Loewner investigation.

- [18] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *Depth extension with an adaptive shift*, working research, 10 September 2026, `papers/shifted-zeta/storage-depth/archive/background/1-critical_path_research.md`. Internal, model-assisted research; independent review remains open.
- [19] Riemann Hypothesis research program, *A depth-shift path controlled by cumulative storage*, working research, 10 September 2026, `papers/shifted-zeta/storage-depth/archive/background/2-cumulative_storage_path.md`. Internal, model-assisted research; the continuation bounds are conditional.
- [20] E. Baker, *Residual-controlled depth extension of finite-horizon Weil positivity*, working draft 0.3, with model assistance disclosed there; see Appendix A, `papers/shifted-zeta/storage-depth/manuscript/storage_depth.tex`. The recorded enclosures use that paper’s working normalization; independent normalization verification and review remain open.
- [21] M. Suzuki, *A canonical system of differential equations arising from the Riemann zeta-function*, RIMS Kokyuroku Bessatsu **B34** (2012), 397–435, especially Section 1.4, [publisher’s PDF](#).